

**SECTION A - READING SKILLS**

**(2 x 10 = 20 Marks)**

**1.** Read the following passage.

10 M

1 Sustainability has become one of the most discussed concerns in environmental policy worldwide. It refers to meeting present needs without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own. This concept recognises the interconnectedness of economic, social, and ecological systems.

2 One major focus of sustainability efforts is reducing waste and promoting recycling. Waste not only pollutes ecosystems but also represents a loss of valuable resources that could be reused. Cities have started programs to separate recyclable materials such as plastics, paper, and metals to reduce landfill volumes.

3 Energy consumption is another critical area. Reliance on fossil fuels contributes to climate change, so many countries are investing in renewable energy sources like solar and wind power. These clean energy options are sustainable because they do not deplete natural reserves or produce harmful emissions.

4 Despite these efforts, challenges remain. Economic growth often conflicts with environmental protection because industrial expansion can increase pollution. Additionally, changing public habits towards waste and energy use requires education and incentives.

5 Technological innovation plays a crucial role in sustainability by offering new ways to reduce environmental impacts. For example, advances in battery storage improve the reliability of renewable energy, while smart grids optimise electricity distribution.

6 Ultimately, achieving sustainability demands cooperation among governments, businesses, and individuals. Only by working together can society ensure a healthy planet that supports both current wellbeing and future prosperity.

7 In conclusion, sustainability is a complex but essential goal that requires balancing development with care for the environment and resources.

(Created for academic usage / 246 words)

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I. What can be inferred about the relationship between economic and environmental goals? (Paragraph 4) [1]

II. All of the following are mentioned as sustainable practices EXCEPT: (Paragraph 2) [1]

A. Separating recyclable materials

B. Reducing landfill volumes

C. Increasing fossil fuel use

D. Promoting recycling

III. Renewable energy sources are preferred because they do not \_\_\_\_\_ natural reserves. (deplete / increase) (Paragraph 3) [1]

IV. Which of the following statements about 'smart grids' in paragraph 5 is TRUE? (Paragraph 5) [1]

- A. They help optimise electricity distribution.
- B. They increase pollution from fossil fuels.
- C. They are a form of renewable energy.

V. sustainability : future generations :: technology : \_\_\_\_\_ (Paragraph 5) [1]

- A. innovation
- B. destruction

VI. Explain why changing public habits is described as a challenge for sustainability. (Paragraph 4) [2]

VII. Match the main ideas to paragraphs 3 and 6:

- A. Importance of renewable energy
- B. Cooperation between sectors is necessary
- C. Waste pollution is inevitable (Paragraph 3) [1]

- A. Paragraph 3 - A; Paragraph 6 - B
- B. Paragraph 3 - B; Paragraph 6 - C
- C. Paragraph 3 - C; Paragraph 6 - A

VIII. Using evidence from paragraphs 2 and 5, discuss how technology contributes to sustainability efforts. [2]

2. Read the following passage.

10 M

1 A recent survey conducted at several high schools investigated student study habits and their impact on academic performance. The survey collected data from 1,200 students, covering aspects such as study duration, preferred study times, and use of digital resources.

2 According to the findings, 65% of students preferred to study in the evening, while only 20% studied in the morning. Additionally, students who studied for more than two hours per day scored, on average, 15% higher on their tests than those who studied for less than one hour. Use of digital resources such as educational apps and online tutorials was reported by 72% of the respondents.

3 Interestingly, the survey revealed that students who combined traditional note-taking with digital tools achieved the best results, with an average test score 10% higher than students who used only one method. The study also noted that distractions, particularly from social media, reduced effective study time by nearly 25%.

4 The surveyors concluded that while study duration is important, the quality and method of studying have a significant influence on academic outcomes. They recommended balanced use of digital and traditional resources and suggested limiting social media use during study hours. Schools may consider incorporating these findings into their study skills programs to help improve student performance.

5 Overall, the survey highlights the importance of deliberate study habits and suggests that students who manage their time and resources well tend to achieve better grades.

(Created for academic usage / 235 words)

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I. According to the survey, what percentage of students preferred to study in the evening? (Paragraph 2) [1]

- A. 65%
- B. 20%
- C. 72%
- D. 25%

II. Quote the exact phrase from paragraph 4 that suggests how schools could help improve student performance. (Paragraph 4) [1]

III. Students who studied for more than two hours per day scored, on average, 15% higher on their tests than those who studied for less than one hour. This shows that longer study time is (more/less) effective. (Paragraph 2) [1]

IV. In paragraph 3, what does the word 'distractions' most nearly mean? (Paragraph 3) [1]

V. What percentage of students used digital resources such as educational apps and online tutorials? (Paragraph 2) [1]

- A. 65%
- B. 20%
- C. 72%
- D. 10%

VI. What can be inferred from the passage about the relationship between social media use and study effectiveness? (Paragraph 3) [1]

VII. How are the ideas of 'combining traditional note-taking with digital tools' and better test scores connected in the passage? (Paragraph 3) [1]

VIII. Explain an implication of the survey's recommendation to limit social media use during study hours. (Paragraph 4) [2]

IX. The survey highlighted the importance of deliberate study habits and suggests that students who manage their time and resources well tend to achieve better \_\_\_\_\_. (Paragraph 5) [1]

**SECTION B - GRAMMAR AND WRITING SKILLS**  
**(3 Questions = 20 Marks)**

3. Complete any 10 of 12 of the following tasks, as directed.

10 M

I. They told the reporter that they \_\_\_\_\_ aware of the situation and were taking action.

II. You \_\_\_\_\_ (must / should) wear gloves to handle chemicals safely.

III. \_\_\_\_\_ of the staff attended the workshop last week.

A. Some

B. Much

C. Any

D. Little

IV. They asked if the package \_\_\_\_\_ delivered by Friday.

V. They told the officer to \_\_\_\_\_ the area immediately for safety reasons.

VI. By this time tomorrow, the storm \_\_\_\_\_ (pass) the coast.

VII. Many users have been \_\_\_\_\_ (complain) about the app freezing during updates.

VIII. Attach the seat \_\_\_\_\_ the frame using the screws provided.

A. on

B. to

C. in

D. at

IX. Applicants are expected \_\_\_\_\_ excellent communication skills.

A. to have

B. having

C. have

D. had

X. Identify the error and correct it: "Many peoples prefer to recycle plastic over glass."

XI. Choose the correct Error/Correction pair: "She don't understand the new software properly."

A. {'error': "don't", 'correction': "doesn't"}

B. {'error': 'understand', 'correction': 'understands'}

C. {'error': 'new', 'correction': 'news'}

D. {'error': 'properly', 'correction': 'proper'}

XII. There are only \_\_\_\_\_ copies of the new novel left.

A. few

B. a few

C. little

D. a little

4. You are Ankit Reddy, a concerned citizen and a university student. Recently, the rise in online scams and data theft has alarmed many internet users. Write a letter to the editor of Daily Horizon expressing concern about digital safety, suggesting measures that individuals and authorities should take. Your letter should be approximately 120 words.

OR

You are Samira Patel, the President of Greenfield High School. There have been frequent water supply interruptions in your residential area of Lakemount City for the past two months, causing major inconvenience to residents. Write a formal letter to Mr. Arjun Mehta, the Municipal Commissioner of Lakemount City, requesting immediate action to restore regular water supply. Your letter should be about 120 words.

5. Your company is deciding between two new running shoe designs to launch this year. The data below compares the designs in terms of cost to produce, customer comfort ratings, and expected durability. Write one cohesive analytical paragraph of about 120 words comparing the two designs by these criteria and recommend which should be launched.

Design Alpha

Cost to Produce: \$45 per pair.

Customer Comfort Rating: 8.5 out of 10.

Expected Durability: 12 months average.

Design Beta

Cost to Produce: \$40 per pair.

Customer Comfort Rating: 8.0 out of 10.

Expected Durability: 15 months average.

OR

You are a member of the school interview panel tasked with selecting one candidate for the position of Mathematics teacher. You have two shortlisted candidates listed below, each with ratings on experience, teaching style, and extra-curricular involvement. Write one cohesive analytical paragraph of about 120 words comparing the candidates on these three criteria and justify which candidate you recommend for appointment.

Candidate A

Experience: 8 years teaching at secondary schools.

Teaching Style: Uses interactive methods encouraging student participation.

Extra-curricular Involvement: Leads the school math club and organizes competitions.

Candidate B

Experience: 5 years teaching including advanced placement courses.

Teaching Style: Focuses on structured lectures with detailed explanations.

Extra-curricular Involvement: Coaches the school chess team and runs tutoring sessions.

**SECTION C - LITERATURE TEXTBOOK**

**(6 Questions = 40 Marks)**

6. “I was his only companion until he started school,” his mother said. “After that I would bring home friends for him. But at night we just did things together. Richie was my whole life after his father died when Richie was in third grade.” She and her son spent almost every evening at the dining room table. “If he didn’t have things to do, I found work for him — not physical work, but learning things,” his mother said. “He liked it. He wanted to learn.”

5 M

Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow:

“Pranjol’s father slowed down to allow a tractor, pulling a trailer-load of tea leaves, to pass. “This is the second-flush or sprouting period, isn’t it, Mr Barua?” Rajvir asked. “It lasts from May to July and yields the best tea.” “You seem to have done your homework before coming,” Pranjol’s father said in surprise. “Yes, Mr Barua,” Rajvir admitted. “But I hope to learn much more while I’m here.”

- (a) What does the term 'second-flush' refer to in the context of tea?
- (b) Which period does the second-flush cover?
- (c) Who is Mr Barua in the extract?
- (d) What is Rajvir's attitude towards learning about tea?

7. The fog comes on little cat feet.

5 M

It sits looking over harbour and city  
on silent haunches and then moves on.

- (i) Identify the poetic device used in this extract.
- (ii) What is the tone or mood created by the poem?
- (iii) What does the phrase "on silent haunches" mean in the context of the poem?
- (iv) What inference can you draw about the poet's view of the fog from this extract?

From the poem 'Dust of Snow' by Robert Frost:

Dust of Snow  
The way a crow  
Shook down on me  
The dust of snow  
From a hemlock tree

- (a) Identify the poetic device used when the crow shakes down the dust of snow. (1m)
- (b) What is the theme or tone conveyed in these lines? Explain with reference to the extract. (2m)
- (c) What does the phrase 'dust of snow' metaphorically signify in the poem? (1m)
- (d) What inference can be drawn about the impact of this incident on the poet's mood? (1m)

8. Answer any four of the following five questions, in about 50 words each:

12 M

- 1. What does the poet imply by 'turning' to live with animals, and how does it reflect his views on humanity's complexities?
- 2. Identify and evaluate three human behaviors mentioned by the poet that contrast with animal behavior, and discuss what this suggests about human nature.
- 3. Analyze the poet's statement about kneeling to humans of the past and discuss its significance concerning respect and tradition.
- 4. Explain the concept of 'tokens' that the poet mentions animals possess, exploring how this relates to the Romantic tradition's view of civilization and true human nature.
- 5. Discuss how Walt Whitman's unconventional style in 'Song of Myself' breaks traditional poetic norms and reflects his nonconformist character.



9. Answer any two of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words:

↵ M

- (i) Why did Anne Frank decide to keep a diary and name her diary friend 'Kitty'?
- (ii) What do the stanzas in parentheses in the poem 'Amanda!' represent?
- (iii) What was the reason for Mr Keesing assigning Anne extra homework, and how did Anne respond?

10. Discuss how the story challenges the typical image of a secret agent through the character of Ausable. How does Ausable's appearance and behavior contribute to the central theme of the story? Provide examples to support your evaluation.

↵ M

OR

Discuss how the theme of economic interests impacting personal relationships is developed through the quarrelsome characters of Lomov, Natalya, and Chubukov in 'The Proposal'. How does Chekhov use these characters to convey a moral message about marriage and social ties?

11. Evaluate the theme and moral message of the play "The Book That Saved the Earth", focusing on how the story portrays the power of knowledge and the importance of books in shaping understanding and preventing conflict.

↵ M

OR

Explain how Gavin Maxwell's relationship with Mijbil the otter reflects the theme of companionship and responsibility. Discuss how Maxwell's feelings and attitudes towards Mijbil develop over the course of the story, and what moral message the chapter conveys regarding caring for an unusual pet.